

Succeeding in a New Role

Starting your first months well

4 psychology approaches · tips & advice — by EvaTalk

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BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Starting your first months well

The first months in a new role set the tone. Between wanting to prove yourself, the flood of information and the pressure to 'succeed fast', you can burn out or pick the wrong priorities.

This guide helps you ease the pressure of the early days, find your place without betraying yourself, and steer your start with a real plan.

Your intention

Your new role (or the one you're aiming for) and what worries you: _____

The 4 approaches

This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

Psychodynamic — understand the root.

CBT — ease the negative thoughts.

Humanistic — reconcile with yourself.

Systemic — act on your environment.

The pressure to prove yourself

A new role often wakes the need to prove your worth immediately, and the fear of being 'found out' (impostor feelings).

Understanding this pressure keeps you from exhausting yourself trying to master everything on day one.

Example

Wanting to 'ace it all' in week one, Sami burned out. Understanding his fear of judgment helped him slow down.

My early-days pressure

What do you think you must prove, and how fast? Where does the urgency come from?

What's realistic

Write what can reasonably be expected of you in month one (vs what you impose).

→ *I don't have to prove everything on day one.*

The early-days thoughts

'I should already master everything', 'they'll see I don't know': these thoughts turn a normal learning phase into a threat.

Reframing them lets you ask questions without shame.

Example

Sure she 'should already know', Nia didn't dare ask anything. Reframing let her learn fast.

Early-days journal

Note: the anxious thought · a fairer version ('I'm new, it's normal to...').

My legitimate questions

List 3 questions you hesitated to ask — and can ask without shame.

→ *Asking questions early is expected — not an admission of incompetence.*

Finding your place without betraying yourself

Finding your place isn't blending into the mold: it's staying yourself while building authentic relationships. Your uniqueness is also what they came looking for.

You were hired for who you are, not for a clone.

Example

Instead of copying the team's style, Léa brought her own way of doing things — and was quickly valued.

What I bring

What do YOU bring that's unique to this role/team?

My first relationships

Whom would you like to get to know first? How to create a sincere first connection?

→ *I was hired for who I am — I stay myself.*

A new-role plan

Concretely: listen and observe before acting, clarify expectations (at 30/60/90 days), map the key players, aim for a realistic first win, and set a sustainable pace.

A plan turns the early fog into clear steps.

Example

By clarifying her 90-day priorities with her manager, Sofia stopped scattering and scored useful points.

My 30/60/90 plan

Note: what I want to understand by 30 days · my first actions by 60 · my target first win by 90.

My mapping

List 5 key players to understand/meet + what you'd like to clarify with them.

→ *Listen first, wins next — I steer my start.*

Practical tips & advice

Tips & advice

- Listen and observe before trying to change everything.
- Clarify expectations with your manager (priorities at 30/60/90 days).
- Spot key players and build connections early.
- Aim for a quick but realistic 'first win'.
- Ask questions: it's expected of someone new.
- Don't try to master it all at once; take notes and pace your energy.

To fill in

My 30/60/90 plan

Deadline	My objective

My mapping

Key player	What I want to clarify

PLAN

Your 4-week plan

Week 1 — Ease the pressure to prove myself.

Week 2 — Reframe the early-days thoughts.

Week 3 — Find my place without betraying myself.

Week 4 — Build my 30/60/90 plan.

Your plan in 3 lines

- What I want to understand first:
- My target first win:
- The key players to meet:

TO CLOSE

Listen first, wins next — you find your place.

Listen first, wins next.

This guide is a coaching and psychoeducation tool, not a substitute for therapy. If you are going through a hard time, please reach out to a professional or a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.